

ArtHound UI redesign — inventory, direction, and execution plan

Status: **PROPOSAL** — awaiting approval. No app code changed. Mockups: open the `.html` files in this folder in a browser (PNG renders alongside).

- `01-tokens.html` — proposed design system (palette, borders, controls, pills, table density, type scale)
- `02-assets.html` — Assets 3-panel viewer
- `03-home.html` — Studio Home dashboard
- `04-reviews.html` — Reviews split view

1 · Inventory findings

~14 screens (8 PageContainer pages, 5 full-bleed tools, auth flows) + ~20 modals. Theme is Tailwind v4 CSS vars in `frontend/src/index.css`. lucide-react icons, sonner toasts.

Systemic issues found:

1. **Saturated purple chrome.** Background `#0d0a1a`, borders `#3a2f6b`, muted text `#a89cd6` — every border and secondary label carries color, so on dense screens the chrome competes with the data instead of receding.
2. **No component primitives.** Buttons/inputs/modals/tables/cards are hand-rolled per file (~2,200 className strings). OrgHub and AdminPanel each define their own `btnPrimary`.
3. **Focus states: 4+ different patterns**, including `focus:ring-primary` in SyntheticDataModal.jsx referencing a CSS var that doesn't exist (bug).
4. **Border opacity chaos:** `border-border`, `/40`, `/50`, `/60` with no semantics.
5. **Button geometry mismatch:** primary `px-4 py-2 rounded-lg` vs secondary `px-3 py-1.5 rounded-md`.
6. **Status colors hardcoded as hex** in Reviews.jsx and ScenarioViewer.jsx instead of shared tokens.
7. **Link color split:** `text-p2` (blue) in DetailModal vs `text-accent` (purple) elsewhere.
8. **Close buttons:** text "×" in some modals, lucide `<X/>` in others.
9. **Density inconsistency:** table rows range `py-1.5` to `py-3`; 14px base font is generous for a data tool.
10. **Empty/loading states ad-hoc:** mixed "Loading..." text vs skeletons, varied empty-state styling.

2 · Design direction: "graphite + violet"

- **Neutral chrome.** Surfaces/borders/secondary text drop to near-neutral graphite with a faint cool cast. The dark identity stays; the lavender haze goes.

- **Purple = action.** Accent `#7c6af4` is reserved for primary buttons, selection (tinted row + 2px left rail), focus rings, and active nav. Because nothing else is saturated, these now pop with zero extra weight.
- **Denser baseline.** 13px UI font (from 14), 12px table cells, 30px rows, 28px controls, tabular numerals, 11px uppercase column headers in `--faint`.
- **Three border tiers.** `--border` (structural), `--border-soft` (rows/dividers), `--border-faint` (hairlines). Replaces ad-hoc opacities.
- **Two radii.** 6px controls, 10px panels/modals. Nothing else.
- **One focus treatment.** 2px accent ring on every focusable control.
- **Status pills everywhere** a status appears in a table — single 12% tint level, colors from one shared module.

3 · Execution plan (phased, each phase shippable)

Phase 1 — Tokens (small diff, app-wide effect)

Rewrite the `@theme` block in `index.css` with the new palette + border tiers + type/density tokens. Add `--color-primary` cleanup (fix the undefined var usage). Keep old var names working (`--color-surface-2` etc.) so no component breaks; add new ones (`--color-border-soft` , `--color-border-faint` , `--color-faint`).

Phase 2 — Primitives (`frontend/src/components/ui/`)

`Button` (primary/secondary/ghost/danger × md/lg), `Input` , `Select` , `Textarea` , `Modal` (overlay + panel + header w/ lucide X + footer), `Pill` / `StatusPill` , `Tabs` , `EmptyState` , `Spinner` / `Skeleton` , `Dropdown` , `DataTable` (sticky header, density, selection rail), `KVRow` . Plus `lib/statusColors.js` (review status, priority, craft colors — removes the hex maps in `Reviews.jsx` / `ScenarioViewer.jsx`).

Phase 3 — Dense tools migration (highest value)

Assets 3-panel → Reviews → OrgHub (Estimates matrix + Workflows + Members) → ScenarioViewer. Adopt `DataTable` + toolbar pattern (search / filters / columns left, bulk + primary actions right), selection bar, status bar with counts.

Phase 4 — Pages + modals sweep

Home dashboards, Vendors/Studios/Inbox, AdminPanel, auth/onboarding screens, then the ~20 modals onto the `Modal` primitive. Delete per-file button/input class strings.

Phase 5 — Polish pass

Empty states, skeletons, keyboard affordances (/ to search), and a final screen-by-screen consistency check against the token sheet.

4 · Open decisions for review

1. **Palette neutrality** — mockups use near-neutral graphite (#131217 bg). Could keep slightly more violet in surfaces if the brand feel reads too cold.
2. **Row density default** — mockups use 30px rows. Could add a per-user density toggle (compact 26 / default 30 / relaxed 36) on DataTable from day one, or defer.
3. **Status pills vs plain text** in very wide tables — pills add scanability but visual weight; could use colored-dot + text for low-key columns.
4. **Scope of Phase 3 vs 4 ordering** — dense tools first (proposed) or quick full-app token flip first, component migration after.